

Trading Platform
Kick-Off:
Requirements and
Architecture Day

What You Will Produce Today

- Read and digest the LEAP Project business requirements specification
- As a team, produce three things: a candidate architecture, an initial project plan and a risk list
- Package the three into a single presentation
- Present it to a panel of business stakeholders this afternoon



Today's Agenda

- 08:00 - 08:30 Welcome, and the requirements specification is issued
- 08:30 - 12:00 Team working session
- 12:00 - 13:00 Lunch
- 13:00 - 14:00 Finish working session and prepare the presentation
- 14:00 - 15:20 Team presentations to stakeholders (20 minutes each, 4 teams)
- 15:20 - 15:50 Panel feedback and cross-team discussion
- 15:50 - 16:00 Close



The Brief

- You have each been issued the LEAP Project Business Requirements Specification
- Read it as a team before you start designing anything
- It describes what the platform must do and the standard of service it must meet
- It does not tell you how to build it. That decision is yours to propose and defend
- Treat it exactly as you would a specification from a real client



Three Deliverables

Everything your afternoon presentation needs to cover

Candidate Architecture

Your proposed design

The technologies you would use

Why you chose them

Initial Project Plan

How you would sequence the work

What has to come first

What could run in parallel

Risk List

What could go wrong

How likely, how serious

What you would do about it



Deliverable 1: Candidate Architecture

- Show how the pieces of the platform fit together and how data flows through it
- Name the technologies you would use, and why you chose them over the alternatives
- Show how the design meets the trust, audit and reporting expectations in the specification, not only the visible features
- A whiteboard sketch or diagram is expected. Polish is not the point today



Deliverable 2: Initial Project Plan

- Show how you would sequence the work, not a finished schedule
- Identify what has to exist before anything else can be built
- Identify what could run in parallel across the team
- Be honest about what you do not yet know enough to plan in detail



Deliverable 3: Risk List

- List the risks you can see in delivering this platform, technical and otherwise
- For each, note how likely it is, how serious it would be, and what you would do about it
- A short, honest list is worth more than a long list copied from a template
- Flag anything in the specification you are still unsure how to satisfy



This Afternoon: Presenting to Stakeholders

- Each team presents for up to 20 minutes, including questions
- The panel plays the role of LEAP Project stakeholders: the Programme Sponsor and colleagues
- Speak to them as stakeholders, not as engineers in a stand-up
- Lead with the business outcome, then explain the architecture that delivers it
- Be ready to defend a decision you made, and to admit one you have not resolved yet



Logistics

- Four teams of five to six, four teams per classroom
- Bring your three deliverables as slides or a shared document, whichever your team presents from best
- Presentation order is drawn at random at 13:45
- Ask your instructor if anything in the specification is unclear. A real programme sponsor would expect that question, not penalise it



Before You Start

- Read the specification as a team
- Design a candidate architecture and justify it
- Sketch an initial plan and an honest risk list
- Present it as if the LEAP Project's stakeholders are deciding whether to fund you
- Next: delivery begins.

